

A decorative border surrounds the central text, featuring stylized green leaves, orange and yellow flowers, and blue bell-shaped flowers on thin stems.

Debate Activity

Debate Assignment

Standards/ Objective

9-10R8: Delineate and evaluate an argument and specific claims in a text, assessing the validity or fallacy of key statements by examining whether the supporting evidence is relevant and sufficient.

9-10R9: Choose and develop criteria in order to evaluate the quality of texts. Make connections to other texts, ideas, cultural perspectives, eras, and personal experiences.

9-10W1: Write arguments to support claims that analyze substantive topics or texts, using valid reasoning and relevant and sufficient evidence.

Students will be able to evaluate and select informational texts to support their claim, and develop arguments to support the claim.

Assignment Details

This activity is the first part of the debate assignment taking place after reading *The Hate U Give* by Angie Thomas.

1. After reading *The Hate U Give* by Angie Thomas, students will conduct research for an upcoming debate. The topic question will be: Does banning books silence marginalized voices such as BIPOC authors.
2. Explain how *The Hate U Give* by Angie Thomas is a banned book in some schools across the district for various reasons including violence and discussions of race.
3. Students will be split into two sides and provided with a graphic organizer to organize their argument. Each group of 2-3 students need to find at least 2 credible articles that support their argument and one that supports the opposing argument.

Assignment Analysis

Strengths

- Strengthens critical thinking skills
- Teaches students to find unbiased sources and works on research skills
- Includes collaboration
- Students recognize and research perspectives that may differ from their own

Weaknesses

1. Students may focus too much on their topic and be close-minded towards the opposing argument
2. Students may not find the topic interesting, and won't take the assignment seriously.

Remedies to the Weaknesses

1. To prevent close-mindedness, encourage students to have empathy towards the other side of the argument regardless of their personal beliefs.
2. On the matter of interest, help students find a personal connection to this topic. Usually if there is a personal connection to a topic, students will be more engaged.



Debate Assignment

Topic:	
Claim:	My opinion:
Reason 1:	Quote/ evidence 1 (with citation):
Reason 2:	Quote/evidence 2 (with citation):
Reason 3:	Quote/evidence 3 (with citation):
Opposing claim:	My response to the opposing claim:
Closing argument:	